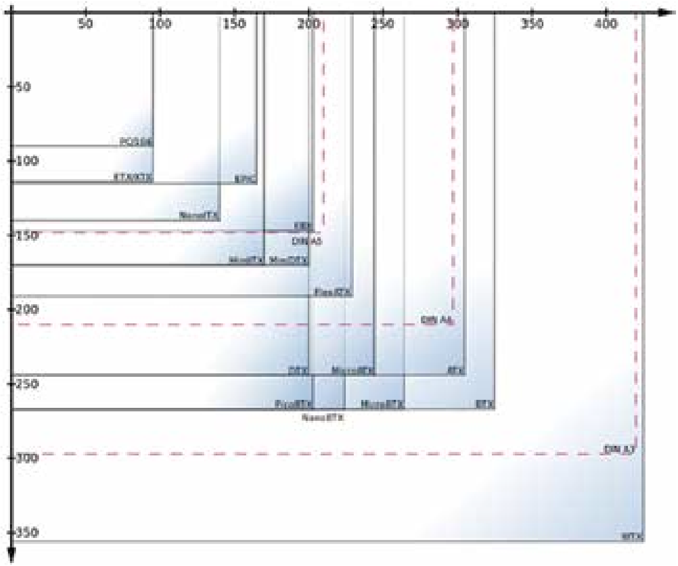

The problem is that manufacturers often make minor modifications to fit in a few extra features and thus end up creating a new form factor, there are over 40 form factors in existence to this day. Smaller form factors are geared towards embedded design while the really big ones are for workstations and servers that use more than one processor and fit in around 128 GB of RAM. We are looking at desktop motherboards which would happen to be one of the following - EATX, ATX, MicroATX, MiniATX and NanoATX. It is obvious that a bigger form factor has more real estate to have a lot more features, even then you will find exceptions where a big motherboard has the most basic of all configurations.

Manufacturers have to bring out a motherboard for all price points. There are entry level motherboards which just bring together a basic PC with a keyboard and mouse. Then there are the enthusiast motherboards which feature all sorts of bells and whistles that can make an enthusiast cry in joy. Let's have a look at the various components that form the motherboard.

Components

The motherboard design has gone through some changes as is common with technology. However, the common parts are